



large, sensitive ears
help detect prey

Gray wolf

Canis lupus

Despite its name, the gray wolf can be black, brown, gray, or almost white. All gray wolves are pack predators, hunting large hooved mammals such as elk, deer, and caribou, and smaller prey such as rabbits and beavers. They also feed on carrion, particularly in winter.

An average wolf pack has seven to eight adults ruled by an alpha male and female. The alpha pair leads hunts, establishes territory, and chooses den sites, reinforcing the pack's bonds through vocalizations such as barks and howls. The alphas mate from January to March. After about three months, the female bears a litter of four to seven pups. The pack nurtures the pups until they are about 10 months old, when some will leave, traveling up to 500 miles (800 km), in search of other wolves.

Successful reintroduction

The light gray Rocky Mountain wolf subspecies (*C. l. irremotus*) was reintroduced to Yellowstone in 1995. Since the wolves' return, elk and deer are more mobile, letting trees and grassland regenerate.

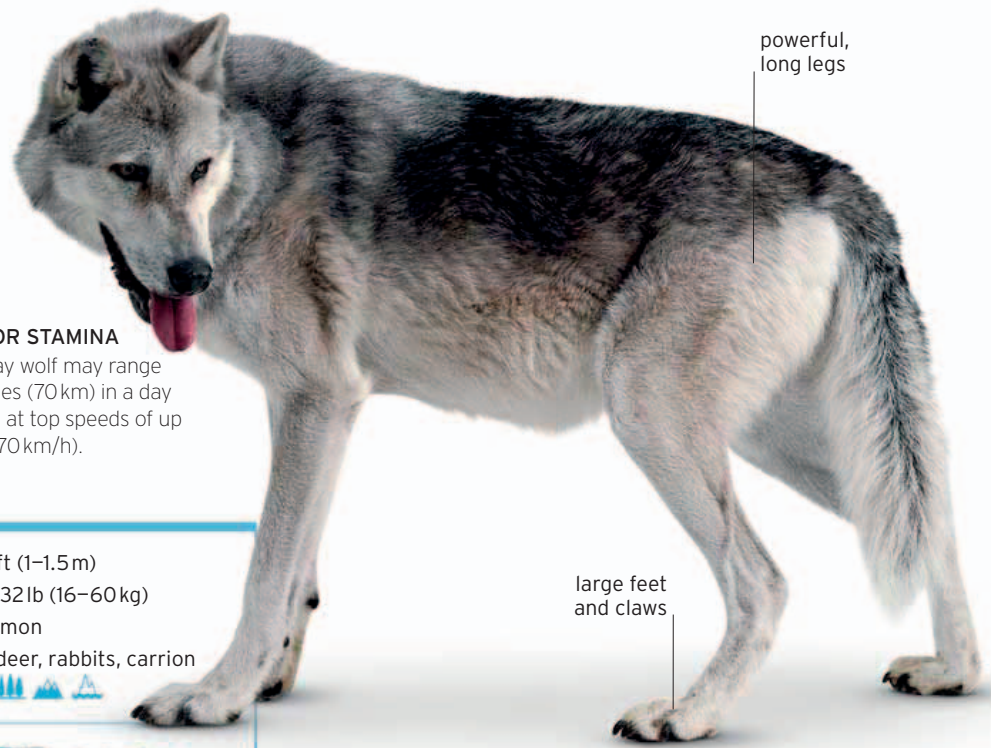
► BUILT FOR STAMINA

An adult gray wolf may range up to 45 miles (70 km) in a day and can run at top speeds of up to 45 mph (70 km/h).

- ↔ 3–5 ft (1–1.5 m)
- ⚖ 35–132 lb (16–60 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🐾 Elk, deer, rabbits, carrion
- 🏠 



N. North America,
Europe, Asia



powerful,
long legs

large feet
and claws

Each wolf has its **own signature howl**

- ↔ 26–43 in (66–109 cm)
- ⚖ 9–34 lb (4–15.4 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🐾 Rabbits, rodents, birds
- 🏠 



S. Canada, US, Mexico



► WINTER FREEZE

Bobcats are more often seen in daylight hours during winter, when food is scarce. They are ambush predators, with markings that allow them to blend in with their surroundings.

Bobcat

Lynx rufus



What the bobcat lacks in tail length it makes up in numbers. More bobcats live in North America than any other native cat species—estimates put the figure at more than a million. Also the most widely distributed cat, it is found as far north as British Columbia.

Adaptable cat

The secret to this tough little cat's success is adaptability. It prefers dense forests, but can easily survive in swamps, mountains, and deserts. Recently, it has added suburban and urban terrain to its habitats. This often brings it into conflict with humans, as it preys on domestic pets and small livestock. In the wild, rabbits form a large part of a bobcat's diet, but it also hunts rodents, birds, beavers, and small deer, mainly at dawn and dusk. At other times, it rests in dens hidden in thickets, hollow trees, or rocky crevices.

Like most cat species, the bobcat is solitary except during the mating season from December to April. After about a two-month gestation period, females give birth to litters of about three cubs, which remain with their mothers for eight months.